Pakistan (and Karzai's outreach to Islamabad), Pakistan was reluctant in openly saying it, but was convinced of India's perverse role in these incidents via Afghanistan (more on this below). Specifically, the resisting Bugti (and Marri) tribe, whose leader Nawab Akbar Khan Bugti had gone underground (and was later killed in an operation by the Pakistan Army), was receiving Indian armed and political support, alleged Pakistan.[40]

Though no forensic evidence exists on India's links with either the Baloch or the TTP insurgencies, Pakistan seriously suspected an Indian hand in both. Mushahid Hussain Sayed, Musharraf's right-hand man, blamed India for training 600 Baloch dissidents (with the help of former UF leaders and Karzai, against whom there was an assassination attempt in April 2008) to handle explosives, use sophisticated weapons, and engineer bomb blasts in training camps on Afghan territory.[41] The R&AW, the MI, and even Indian diplomats were blamed for using their contacts in the NDS and Afghanistan's Ministry of Tribal Affairs to recruit tribal elders from Jalalabad, Kandahar, and Pakistan's North and South Waziristan tribal agencies to destabilise Pakistan. India maintained a stony silence on Pakistan's allegations. But when pushed, New Delhi demanded evidence of its involvement that never came. Having failed to present evidence, Pakistan began resorting to techniques it was most comfortable with and recruited Shakoor for the job. It was in 'response to the [role of the] military intelligence that Pakistan decided to attack our embassy in 2008', says Khare.[42] The 324 Field Intelligence Unit attached to the Peshawar-based XI Corps of the Pakistan Army was, allegedly, involved in the bombing with the decision to undertake it having been linked to the then DG-ISI Nadeem Taj.[43] A LeT recruit trained by the ISI, and logistically supported by the Haqqani network, Shakoor was targeting Mehta, and succeeded in doing so.

An incensed Narayanan publicly called the ISI the 'villain of the piece' (a claim supported by his Afghan counterpart Zalmay Rassoul).[44] Indian intelligence agencies had been tracking increased LeT movement west of Quetta since 2006. New Delhi saw LeT's rise in FATA and Afghanistan as a move by Pakistan army to influence other militant groups in the region to toe Islamabad's line.[45] Still, with India's policy on conciliatory lines, the embassy bombing did not derail New Delhi's composite dialogue with Islamabad.[46] In order to assuage